



Doors open at 9. Be with us by 9:40. Pick up your child's lanyard, **scan it**, and follow their progress through the day.

Hello, and thank you for entering.

I'm Matt Walker, chief arbiter on Sunday.

Please read this before Sunday so everyone knows what happens and when.

It goes best when every family arrives knowing the plan.

First: ECF membership, and your child's rating code

Every player in a London Junior qualifier must be an English Chess Federation member, and Sunday's games count towards their rating only if we have their **rating code**: six digits and a letter, like **123456A**. It is **not** the membership number, which starts ME. Please reply to this email with the code.

If your child has never been an ECF member, **the first year of Junior Gold membership is free**: join at englishchess.org.uk, choose Free Junior Gold, and complete the checkout even though nothing is charged. The rating code is issued with membership; send it on when it arrives, even after Sunday. If you are not sure, reply and say so and we will look it up.

Sunday's timetable

09:00	Doors open at the village hall , Long Ashton Community Centre, BS41 9DP.
09:40	Latest arrival. Check-in closes; anyone not checked in misses round 1.
09:50	Players walk to the pavilion and find their round 1 board.
10:00	Round 1
11:15	Round 2
12:30	Round 3
13:30	Lunch, 45 minutes
14:15	Round 4
15:30	Round 5
16:45	Round 6
17:45	Prize-giving in the village hall
18:00	Home

When you arrive

- 1** Come into the village hall. The lanyards are laid out on a table, in section colours, A to Z; find your child's.
- 2** Scan the small square code on it with your phone camera and your child's page opens.
- 3** Tap the yellow **We're here** button, then Submit. That is check-in done; there is no queue.
- 4** Lanyard on. At 9:50 players go to the pavilion and find their board; parents stay in the village hall.

No smartphone, or the code won't scan?
Tell any blue badge and they will check you in.



Following your child's day

The page you opened from the lanyard follows your child all day. Keep it open on your phone. It shows their board number for each round, their opponent, the result the moment the arbiter enters it, their points and place in the section, and a countdown to the next round. Children find their board by the number on the table; the page and the big screen in the village hall both show it.

Who is responsible for your child. Your child is your responsibility, or their carer's, for the whole day, with one exception: while they are in the pavilion playing a game, the arbiters are responsible for them. Between rounds, at lunch, and from the moment their game ends, they come back to you in the village hall. Please stay on site all day.

During play

- **No parents in the pavilion while games are on, and no watching through the door or the windows.** This is an LJCC rule, so please don't ask the arbiters to bend it. Parents stay in the village hall for every round; the big screen there shows pairings, results and the next-round countdown.
- **No phones in the pavilion.** Players leave phones and smartwatches with you before each round.
- Quiet around the pavilion, please, even between rounds. Younger children are still playing.
- Players: if anything is wrong at the board, put your hand up and wait. An arbiter will come. Never argue with your opponent, and never ask a parent.
- Arbiters cannot say whether a position is checkmate. Players work that out themselves.

Rules at the board

- Six rounds of rapid chess. 20 minutes each, plus 10 seconds added every move.
- Touch a piece and you move it. Let go and the move is made.
- Illegal move: first time, a warning and a blue counter goes next to your clock. Second time, two minutes added to your opponent's clock. Third time, the game is lost. The count resets every game.
- Results are entered by the arbiter at the board. Shake hands, wait for the arbiter, then reset the pieces.
- An odd number of players in a section means one child sits out each round and scores a full point. The pairing program chooses who, and nobody sits out twice.

Missing a round, or leaving early

This is a Swiss tournament: every child is expected to play all six rounds. If your child must leave early or miss a round, **tell an arbiter before the round is paired**, so nobody is left waiting at an empty board. A round missed scores **zero**; we are not offering half-point byes. If a section has an odd number of players, the pairing program gives one child a **one-point bye** for that round, and nobody gets it twice. These are the London Junior Chess Championships' rules for qualifiers.



How pairings and scoring work

A win scores **1 point**, a draw $\frac{1}{2}$, a loss **0**. Nobody is knocked out: every child plays all six rounds. Before each round the pairing program matches players on the same score, so winners play winners and everyone meets children of about their own strength. Nobody plays the same opponent twice, and colours alternate as far as possible. Final places are by points; ties are split by the opponents' total score, shown as **BH** on the live page.

How places are decided at the end of the day

Final places are by points. Children on the same points are separated by the **Buchholz tie-break**, the column marked **BH** on the live page and on the standings. Buchholz adds up the final scores of all of your child's opponents. The thinking is simple: of two children on 4 points, the one whose opponents went on to score well had the harder road, so they place higher.

Three things follow. It is not something a child can play for; the only way to raise it is to play, and beat, good players. It keeps changing until the very last game, because when an opponent from round 2 wins in round 6, your child's Buchholz rises too, so a child can move up or down the table without playing. And it is why we never announce final places until the last board in the section has finished.

Children still level after Buchholz are separated by a fixed list, so nobody has to make a judgement on the day: first the result of the game between them, if they played; then **Sonneborn-Berger**, which counts in full the scores of the opponents your child beat and by half the scores of those they drew with; then the number of wins. Only if every one of those is level is the place shared.

Golden Tickets to London

This is a qualifier for the London Junior Chess Championships. Score enough points out of six and your child earns a place in the finals in December. The LJCC sets the pass marks.

4 of 6

U8: the U8 Final

 $3\frac{1}{2}$ or 4

U10 and U12: Minor final

 $4\frac{1}{2}+$

U10 and U12: Major final

Your child's page shows how many points they still need.

Qualifying doesn't enter your child automatically; we send results to the LJCC, then you register at ljcc.co.uk.

A child who qualifies for the Major cannot play the Minor.



Certificates, trophies and medals

- **Every player gets a printed London Junior Chess Championships certificate.** They are laid out on tables in the village hall from 9am; collect your child's whenever you like during the day.
- **Trophies for the winner and medals for second and third** in each section are presented at the prize-giving at 17:45 in the village hall. Everyone is welcome; please stay for it.
- **A Blundr certificate of your child's day**, with every opponent and every result, follows by email in the week after.

Parking

The centre's own car park is on Keedwell Hill, just past the doctors' surgery. If it is full, park on the surrounding roads or at **Theynes Croft public car park**, off Long Ashton Road, BS41 9NA, about ten minutes' walk.

Lunch and refreshments

Sandwiches, cakes, fruit, teas and coffees are on sale in the village hall all day.

Card payments only.

What not to worry about

- A chess set or clock. Every board is set up and we provide the clocks. Two boards in the village hall are for going over games; bring your own set by all means.
- Knowing the competition rules. A rules card sits on every playing table, the arbiters are there to help, and the rules go up on the big screen in the village hall between rounds.

What to bring

- A water bottle for the pavilion.
- A warm layer for the walk between the buildings.
- Something quiet for between rounds: a book, a puzzle or a chess app.
- Patience. Six rounds is a long day for a young player, and the last round often matters most.

Who's who

Arbiters and organisers wear a **bright blue badge** with their role on it. Children's badges carry their section colour.

ARBITER · ORGANISER

U8

U10

U12

Any question on the day: ask any blue badge.

First aid

Catherine Walker, organiser, with the first-aid cross on her lanyard, usually in or around the kitchen.



Finding your way



Map © OpenStreetMap contributors.

The grounds

Children may use the play area between rounds, with you.

The bowling green is out of bounds to everyone; please keep children off it.

The terrace outside the pavilion overlooks it, so it is the obvious temptation.

The official record of pairings and results is the event page on Tornelo:

tornelo.com/chess/orgs/blundr/events/bristol-junior-open. If our live page and Tornelo ever disagree, Tornelo is right. If you lose the lanyard, any blue badge can give you the link to your child's page. The organisers may take photos of the event for the website and socials. Questions before Sunday: reply to this email.